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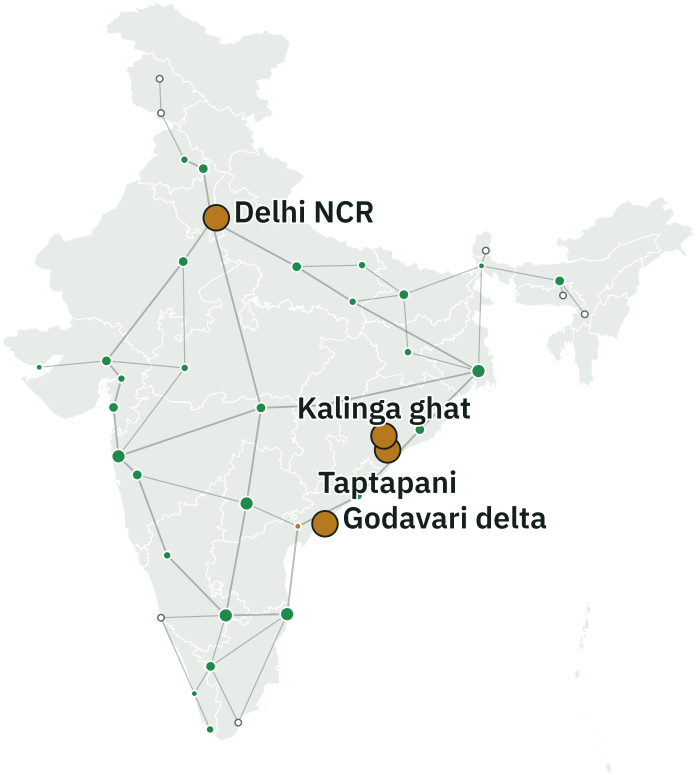
Delhi's ban on outside trucks costs a delivery day

● NETWORK: AMBER

BEFORE DIWALI · 7 DAYS TO DHANTERAS · 9 DAYS TO DIWALI

For e-commerce, D2C and consumer-goods teams delivering orders and stocking shops through Diwali.

From Sunday, Delhi turns away trucks and vans from other states built to BS-IV, the emission standard before today's BS-VI; only BS-VI, CNG and electric goods vehicles get in[1,2]. That lands five days before Dhanteras on the 6th, the busiest week for shop top-ups and gift parcels in India's biggest consumer city. Meanwhile Arnab's rain shut two ghat roads in south Odisha on Thursday[3], and Andhra's delta roads are mending slowly.



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for peak week: busy, but delivery promises hold
● AMBER something is slowing deliveries beyond normal peak
● RED deliveries largely stopped across a state or city, or a courier embargo on the route

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Wed 21 Oct** Delhi on Stage I of GRAP, its pollution action plan: no truck curbs yet[4]
- **Sat 31 Oct** Cane farmers may block the Pune–Bengaluru highway near Belagavi
- **Sun 1 Nov** Delhi turns away BS-IV trucks and vans from other states
- **Fri 6 – Sat 7 Nov** Warehouse crews leave Delhi, Ludhiana and Mumbai
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham
- **Fri 13 – Mon 16 Nov** Chhath keeps east UP and Bihar crews away from city hubs

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+1*	+0	+1–2*	+2–3*	+0	+0
AMBER	GREEN	AMBER	AMBER	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely impact (#days) on delivery promise up to Diwali within the region, specific to certain cities or pincodes, beyond what is expected for the season.

Delhi shuts out BS-IV goods vehicles from Sunday, and transporters threaten blockades

North · Delhi, and the Gurugram, Sonipat, Ghaziabad and Noida warehouses that stock it

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Transporters call it a sudden three-month ban, and say 10,000 to 12,000 trucks from outside come into Delhi every day, ETV Bharat reports[1]. That is their count, not the government's. So who carries Delhi's Diwali stock from Sunday? Whoever owns a newer truck, of course: the rule covers light, medium and heavy goods vehicles alike, vans included[2].

- **Delhi and the NCR warehouses that feed it** North · +1 day Shop top-ups and parcels on BS-IV trucks and vans stop at the border from 1 Nov, and transport unions threaten a chakka jam (a road blockade), no date set[5]. I'd expect a day's slip into the city, worst in the Dhanteras week.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Before Sunday, ask each carrier how many of its vans into Delhi are BS-IV; those loads need a compliant van, or a day more.
- Keep Delhi promises at +1 from 1 Nov until the blockade threat is settled; orders placed after Tue 3 Nov are the ones that can miss Dhanteras, my estimate.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Move Delhi's Dhanteras and Diwali shop stock in on Friday and Saturday while BS-IV trucks still enter, and book BS-VI or CNG trucks for the top-ups after that.

Andhra's delta roads mend, and Arnab's rain shuts two ghats in south Odisha

South, East · Konaseema and West Godavari; Gajapati and Kandhamal, behind Brahmapur

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

By Thursday night Andhra had traffic back at 99 of 133 disrupted spots, but 40 breaches were open, worst in West Godavari and Konaseema, so delta vans still detour, Deccan Chronicle reports[6].

- **Konaseema and West Godavari** South · +1 to +2 days Vans get round the open breaches on detours; I'd expect a day or two extra into the delta towns.
- **Taptapani ghat (NH-326), Brahmapur to Gajapati** East · +2 to +3 days A landslide stopped all traffic on Thursday and stretches of road washed away near Mohana[3]; I'd expect no vans into Gajapati's towns until it is cleared, at least into next week.
- **Kalinga ghat (NH-157), into Kandhamal** East · +2 days Fresh boulders halted traffic on Thursday and machines are clearing them, Pragativadi reports[7]; I'd expect Kandhamal's orders to wait a day or two at Brahmapur.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Set Gajapati and Kandhamal pin codes (761 and 762) at +3 until both ghats reopen, so a Dhanteras order there has to ship by Sunday.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Hold sweets and gifting stock for Kandhamal and Gajapati at Brahmapur until the ghats reopen, then send it first; a truck sent up a shut road only waits there.

What next: A fresh Bay low may become a depression by Saturday and head for the Andhra coast, Eenadu reports[8]; rain there keeps the delta's detours open longer.

Pune–Bengaluru highway (NH-48), Belagavi

South · Open; cane farmers threaten a blockade from Saturday

GREEN

Cane farmers say they will block the highway in Belagavi district from Saturday if the state announces no cane price by Friday evening, Urban Acres reports[9]. Is that a real risk? Well, in mid-October they held it for two days at three toll plazas, and police told drivers to avoid NH-48 altogether[10]. If they do, I'd expect Pune–Bengaluru loads to lose a day on the Miraj–Gokak detour.

SOURCES

Built from public sources only. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. If I am wrong, we'll find out in the subsequent weeks. Cost of delay: High: the delivery misses Dhanteras or Diwali, so the sale is lost or the order comes back; Medium: late, but still before the festival, or stock reaches shops after peak buying; Low: a delay with little effect on sales.

1. ETV Bharat: transporters on Delhi's BS-IV ban, 28 Oct
2. The Tribune: no BS-IV goods vehicles in Delhi from 1 Nov, 16 Oct
3. The News Mill (ANI): landslide blocks Taptapani ghat, 29 Oct
4. Outlook: GRAP Stage I invoked in Delhi-NCR, 21 Oct
5. The Hans India: transporters threaten chakka jam, 29 Oct
6. Deccan Chronicle: Andhra's cyclone restoration, 29 Oct
7. Pragativadi: fresh landslide at Kalinga ghat, 29 Oct
8. Eenadu: another cyclone threat for Andhra, 30 Oct
9. Urban Acres: cane farmers threaten NH-48 blockade, 30 Oct
10. South First: NH-48 blocked a second day, 14 Oct